

Scientific Writing

Lesson 1: Introduction to scientific Writing. Peer reviewing.



Getting to know each other

Always sit next to another course participant, and change pairs every week, as we'll be working together .

Get to know some course participants by sharing:

- who you are
- where you come from
- what you are studying
- what your motivation is for attending the course
- what your research focus is
- another few facts about yourself



Lesson objectives

- Introduce you to the course, assignments and peer reviewing.
- Learn about the genre and features of scientific writing.
- Focus on some sources to support your scientific writing.
- Examine reviewing in general and peer reviewing in this course.



This course aims to...

- Support participants in drafting a scientific manuscript such as a research article or thesis.
- Use authentic materials to examine and analyse as examples of scientific text production.
- Guide participants in searching for, identifying and applying academic writing practices.
- Guide participants in drafting and refining their own manuscripts.
- Practise writing, peer reviewing and revising.
- Focus on the structure of an article, a thesis, and a research proposal.
- Provide guidance on and address problems with English language use in academic settings.
- Help participants to learn to write effectively, concisely and clearly

Requirements

Requirements for acquisition of 2 credit points: candidates will

- submit (upload) 4 satisfactory written assignments (for portfolio), as well as upload 2 other assignments to Padlet / ADAM, as specified,
- review 4 assignments of fellow-students thoroughly and on time according to the schedule,
- read and participate actively in the discussion of other course participants' texts and class materials in class and in manuscript clinics, and
- attend all lectures with no more than one absence (minimum 7 out of 8 lectures)
- attend at least 2 of the manuscript clinics.

Students are assessed by means of a **portfolio** (pass/fail) containing the first drafts as well as the final improved versions of the four peer-reviewed assignments that are uploaded to ADAM.

Homework ± 90-180 minutes / week

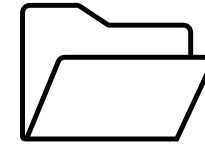
Portfolio

To earn the 2 credits for the course, you need to submit a portfolio consisting of:

1. ONE file in WORD format, containing
2. the **first, unreviewed version**
3. followed by the **final improved version**
4. of each of the **FOUR reviewed assignments** (assignments 3-6).

The portfolio text should contain **no comments or markup**, apart from indicating the **moves or sections**. As you write, save a first draft of each reviewed assignment in your portfolio document, so that you have a 'clean' copy, without any comments.

Focus on improving the texts according to the course input, my comments and those of your reviewers.



Course structure: Lessons and 'Manuscript Clinics'

- 8 in-class input lessons of 90 minutes – attendance of at least 7 required
- 15 minute-long 'Manuscript Clinics' (guided writing) after lessons, starting the second week
- 4 online Manuscript Clinics of 90 minutes, attendance of at least 2 required. Work on your **own texts in** MCs with your peer reviewer and under the guidance of the teacher. Also review other students' texts and discuss them.

ADAM and Padlet



In this course all materials and information are posted on the **ADAM workspace** for this course:

https://adam.unibas.ch/goto_adam_crs_1875186.html

Here you upload the various drafts of your assignments and your peer's and the lecturer's comments.



Access Turnitin in the ADAM workspace folder '4 Assignments and Turnitin plagiarism check' . Upload the Turnitin similarity report to the right folder on ADAM.



We use a **Padlet page** to post some assignments and share information: https://sz-unibas.padlet.org/RianaPaola_szunibas/h8j5bz89xcbdw9vg

Course materials are under copyright

The course materials are intended for your personal use only. Kindly do not distribute them to outside parties in any way or upload them elsewhere.



Use and declaration of resources to support your writing (e.g., assistance from other persons, texts, digital resources and text processing tools)

- Principles and laws regarding intellectual property and academic integrity apply to this course.
- You must familiarize yourself with these principles and laws and sign a declaration of intellectual integrity. You are advised to write using your own words, sentence structure, expression, etc., so you can learn to write using appropriate style, and by learning from your own mistakes.
- **Download the declaration from the ADAM workspace, sign it and upload the signed document (with your name in the document name) to the same folder again.**



Guidelines «Citing AI Tools» How to use tools based on artificial intelligence



Study the above document that outlines the University of Basel's guidelines on the ADAM workspace for the course.



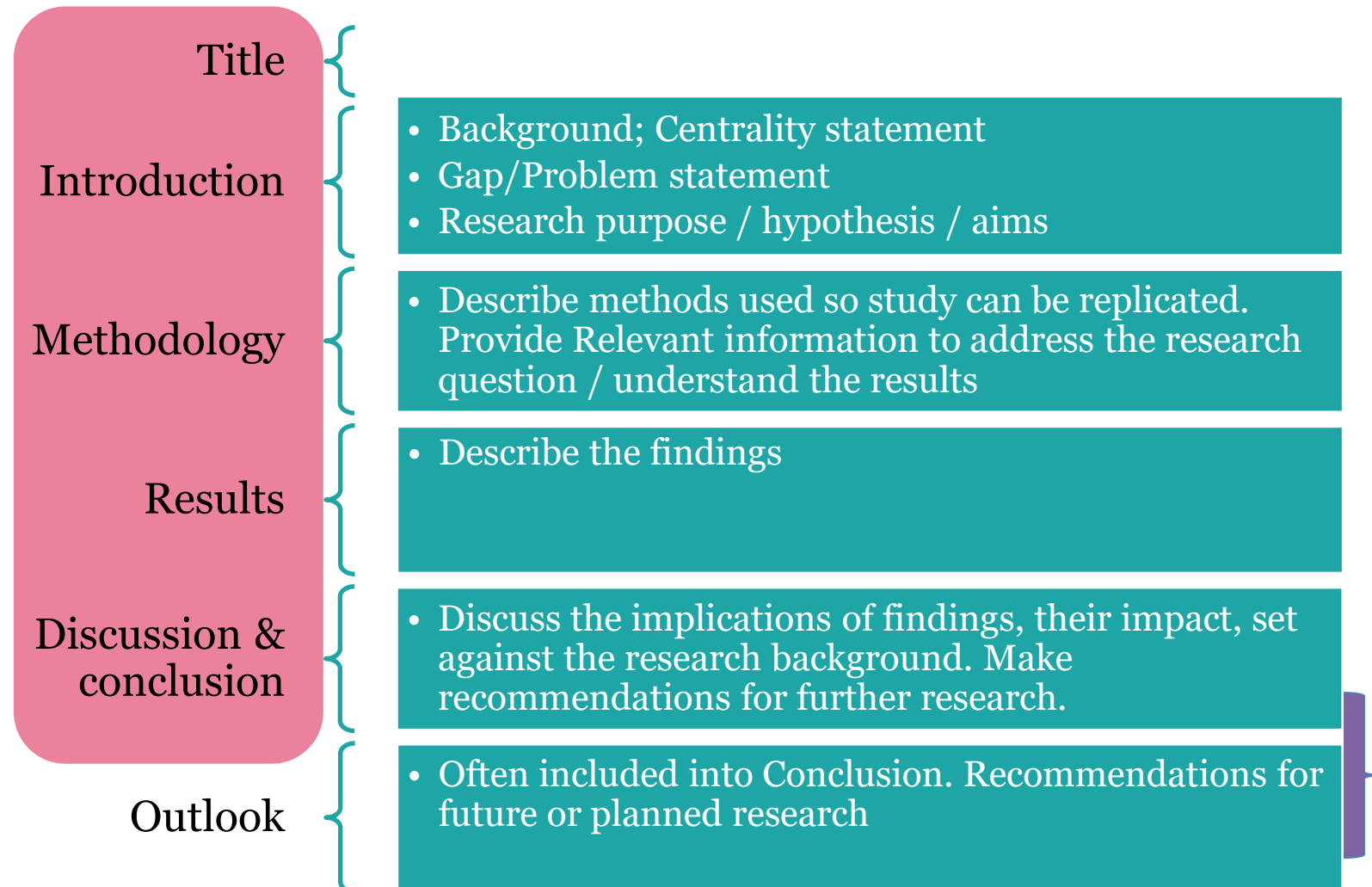
Study, sign and upload the declaration of intellectual integrity.

Read and submit this declaration of intellectual integrity (on ADAM workspace)

- All work submitted during the course is my own, unless declared otherwise.
- I have acknowledged all collaborations, and have properly used and cited all sources, such as texts and text processing tools.
- When using digital/AI-supported writing tools, I have acknowledged them in full by highlighting the sections and declaring the sources in the margin, and by including a separate section "Overview of tools used", with their product name, my source of supply (e.g. URL) and information on the functions of the software used as well as the scope of use.
- In the preparation of assignments for this course, I have worked independently throughout and in a controlled manner in the use of digital/ AI-supported writing tools. I hereby confirm that I accept these regulations and will only use resources and tools in ways that that are allowed.



General structure of a scientific article, thesis or proposal (See Script lesson 1 p.7)



Getting your article accepted for publication – attend to 4 important criteria

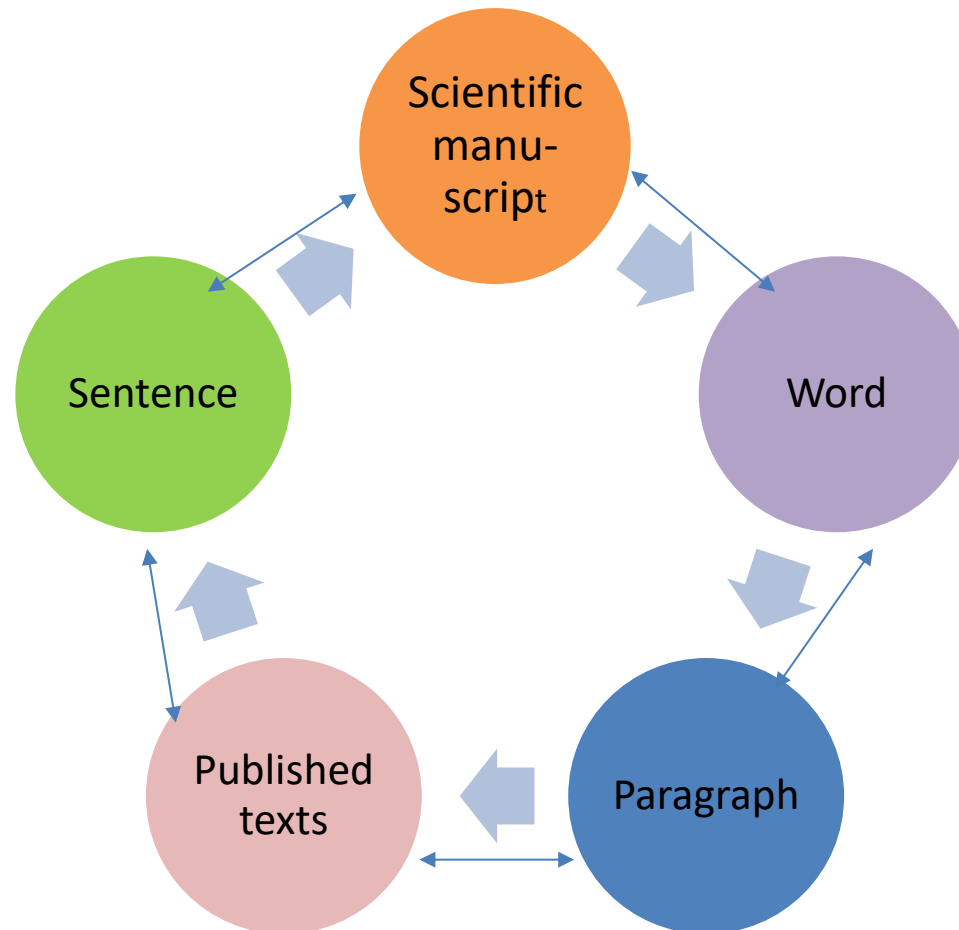
20 to 30 percent of manuscripts get rejected even before they reach the reviewers!

These are some of the main reasons for rejection:

- **Unmet language standards:** A manuscript is quickly judged on its quality .
- **Wrong journal:** Mismatch between the journal's scope and your research topic.
- **Improper articulation of data:** Many manuscripts stray from the goal in an effort to have a detailed paper.
- **Faults in approach:** Faulty research study approach is reflected in several manuscripts.



In this course, we combine various aspects of language use to provide insights to feed into final text production.



What is scientific writing? What is science writing?

Scientific writing

is technical writing by a scientist, with an audience of peers – usually other scientists. For example, journals like the *BMJ*, *Nature* and *Science* publish scientific writing.

Science writing

is writing about science for the popular media. The audience is much more general -- anyone with an interest in science. Science writing is published in *Scientific American* or *Discover Magazine*, or even *National Geographic*, *Time Magazine*, *The Economist*, etc. This genre of reporting on science has gained great interest and importance over the last 2 decades.

A person with a backpack is standing on a rocky outcrop, looking out over a vast, hazy mountain range under a clear blue sky. The mountains are layered, creating a sense of depth. The person is seen from behind, wearing a dark jacket and a backpack.

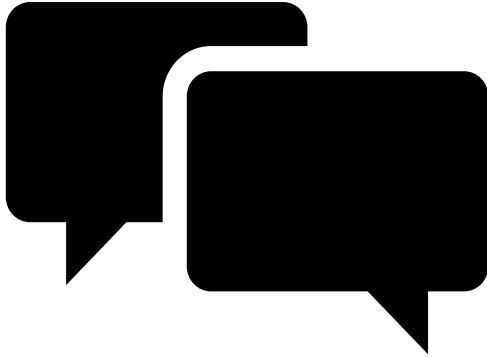
A journey of a
thousand miles
begins with a
single step.

—
Lao Tzu

#DAILYCALM

Calm

Talk to each other about your research manuscript: thesis, article, proposal



- What are the requirements for your thesis/article?
- Do you have to do coursework and examinations too? If so, describe.
- Do you have to make an oral presentation of your study? If so, what are the requirements?
- Who will be your audience/readers?
- How do you plan to structure the thesis?
- What is your time frame for the research?
- What are some problem areas or questions you currently have about your study?

Academic genres (types of text)

Identify 3 academic text types you know.

- What characteristics do they share?
- What audiences are these texts written for?
- What are their purposes?
- What do the scholarly community expect from each genre / text types?

Characteristics of scientific texts you are using as sources or in your scientific writing

- How are they **structured**?
- What are the **characteristics** of the **language** used in these texts? Is there a typical kind of language used?
- How do the **structure and language style** differ between scientific texts and texts that are not published in scientific journals?

Discuss the **scholarly community's expectations** of style and structure in your field of study.

Aims of academic/ scientific writing

- Main aim: **inform**.
- Most important language-related goals: **clarity and economy (conciseness)** - keep it clear and short.
- Goal is **NOT** to *sound* intelligent, but to **get your intelligent point across**. Complicated textbooks and articles *sound* smart... But if you try to sound smart, you miss the most important goal—communicating and being understood.
- Your readers can't read your mind—they can only read your paper. You have only one chance...

***‘The knack (skill/trick)
for all students
regardless of discipline
is to pinpoint what is
required and model your
work accordingly.’***

- Do you agree with this statement?
Why/Why not?
- To what extent is an academic writer free to deviate from the ‘requirements’ or ‘models’ prescribed or used in the scholarly community?
- What are the possible advantages and disadvantages of adhering to or deviating from the expectations of the scholarly community?

Adhere to the university’s code and guidelines.

Linguistic features of academic style 1

- **Vocabulary shift in verbs** preference for single verbs) eg. *'implement'* rather than 'put into practice'. Two-part/phrasal verbs are rare (e.g. 'set up', 'look into')
- **Vocabulary shift in nouns**: Long noun phrases, eg. *'The study of DNA as the carrier of human genetic information has developed exponentially during this decade.'*
- First person singular (I) seldom used (except in social sciences). 'We' increasingly used in certain sections.
- Verb contractions are not used ('should not' rather than 'shouldn't')

Linguistic features of academic style 2

- Use of **indirect** rather than direct **questions**, e.g., ‘It is important to understand *why antibiotic resistance has increased*.’ rather than ‘So why has antibiotic resistance increased?’
- Both **active and passive voice** in various parts of the paper: ‘This model can be used to optimize water supply.’ (Passive voice) ‘These findings indicate that ...’ (Active voice)
- **Condensed/Compact style**: ‘Choosing the most appropriate method may be difficult.’ rather than ‘It may be difficult to make a decision about the appropriate method that should be used.’

Concise expression: Eliminate unnecessary words

Compare the wordy and the concise sentences below:

WORDY: “The expected prevalence of intellectual disability, based on the assumption of a normal distribution of intelligence in the population, is stated to be theoretically about 2.5%.”

WORDY parts underlined: “The expected prevalence of intellectual disability, based on the assumption of a normal distribution of intelligence in the population, is stated to be theoretically about 2.5%.”

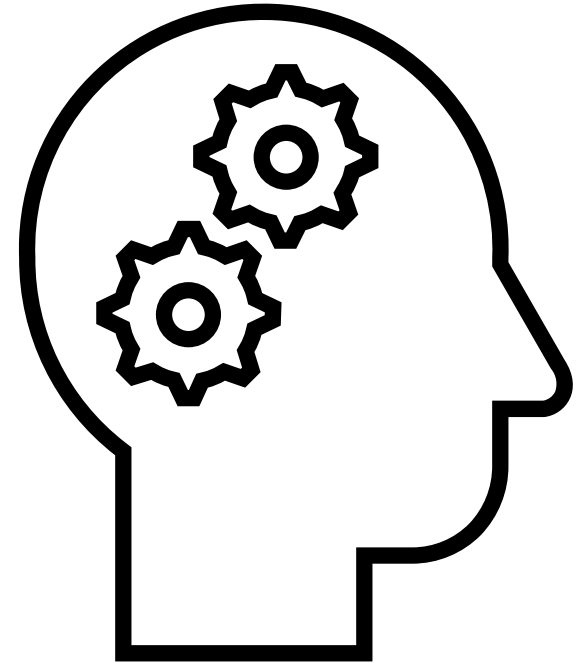
Verbose /Wordy expression is eliminated and expressed more *concisely*.

- “The expected prevalence of intellectual disability, if intelligence is normally distributed, is 2.5%”

Formal and informal language use exercises

Examine these sentences and paragraphs and **highlight** the instances of informal language use. Thereafter, rewrite the sentences in a more formal way, keeping in mind the characteristics of academic language outline above.

1. Up to now people haven't **really looked much into the relationship between mobile** phone use and the amount of sport people do.
2. You can use this model to make recycling of plastic more efficient.
3. So why did the financial crisis occur? There are many reasons.
4. There are several studies in epidemiology that have shown that when people don't drink too much, they have a lower risk of developing heart disease in comparison to those people who drink a lot of alcohol (Adapted from Swales and Feak 2012:26).



Find a shorter way to say it

A majority of	most
A number of	many
Are of the same opinion	agree
At the present moment	now
By means of	by
Less frequently occurring	rare
All three of the	the three
Fewer in number	fewer
Give rise to	cause
In all cases	always
In a position to	can
In close proximity to	near
In order to	to

Resources for academic writing

Thesauri and academic dictionaries. Online dictionaries (e.g. Linguee, dictionary.com). Be careful – mistakes on Leo.

Digital/Artificial Intelligence support – if declared and used responsibly

Academic phrasebank: <http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/>

Academic writing books and websites, such as *Writing academic English* (Skern), *Academic Vocabulary in use*, *Oxford Grammar for EAP*

Digital/Artificial Intelligence-based writing resources – sign declaration of intellectual integrity

Machine translation (e.g. DeepL, Google translate) -
declare

Chatbots – text generation/production (e.g. ChatGPT) –
not permitted

AI-Based text editing or writing tools, e.g. Grammarly,
DeepL Write , Trinka - declare

The academic phrasebank

<http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/>

- Resource of phrases for each section of a scientific article (IMRaD) and for functions such as describing trends, comparing and contrasting, etc. It can help you find just the right phrase for a section – and even unblock writer's block!
- Use the phrase and develop it in your own way.
- Reusing the neutral generic phrases is not plagiarism, as you are not stealing people's ideas, but just using typical phrases to express your own ideas.

Demonstration of Academic Phrasebank

Examples of phrases for introducing a field of study, indicating the gap in previous research

<http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/introducing-work/>

- Previous studies of X have not dealt with ...
- Researchers have not treated X in much detail.
- Such expositions are unsatisfactory because they ...
- Most studies in the field of X have only focused on ...
- Such approaches, however, have failed to address ...
- Previous published studies are limited to local surveys.
- Previously published studies on the effect of X are not consistent.

Examples of phrases for comparing and contrasting

<http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/compare-and-contrast/>

- In the trial, women made more/fewer errors than men.
- Women tend to have greater/less verbal fluency than men.
- Women are more/less likely than men to perform well in tests.
- Women are more/less accurate in tests of target-directed motor skills.
- Women tend to perform better/worse than men on tests of perceptual speed.
- Women are more/less likely to suffer from X when the front part of the brain is damaged.

Task: Distinguish between reusable and non-reusable phrases in texts

1. The research to date has focused on x rather than y.
 2. Deliberately and incisively debunks such myths..
 3. The main weakness of this study was the lack of..
 4. It has become a catchword used to label and delegitimise political movements...
 5. While a variety of definitions of the term x have been suggested, this paper will use the definition first proposed by X, who saw it as ...
- 2 and 4 are too specific and would be plagiarism

Task: distinguish between reusable and non-reusable phrases (2)

6. Taken together, these findings suggest a role for...

7. Much of the research up to now has been descriptive in nature.

8. Dawkins is deaf to theology.

9. In this paper I argue that...

10. The findings of the current study are consistent with...

Number 8 also has very specific language use – plagiarism if you copy it

What to do
when you
have 'hit a
wall' /
have writer's
block, and
do not
manage to
write any
further

Do freewriting/Generative writing

Start writing, even if what you are writing seems uncertain and unsuitable.

Gives confidence

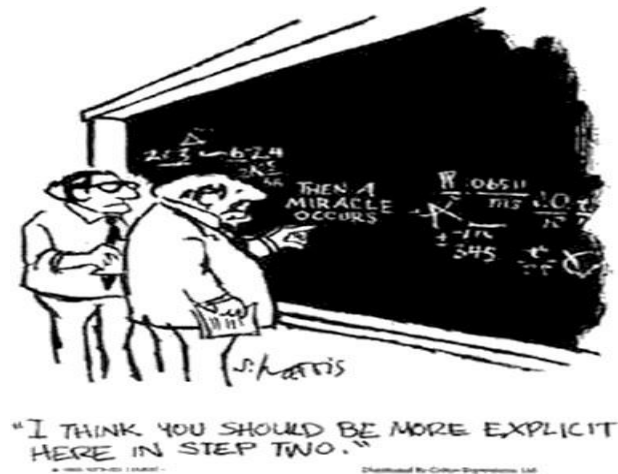
Provides a draft to use as a basis

Unblock writer's block

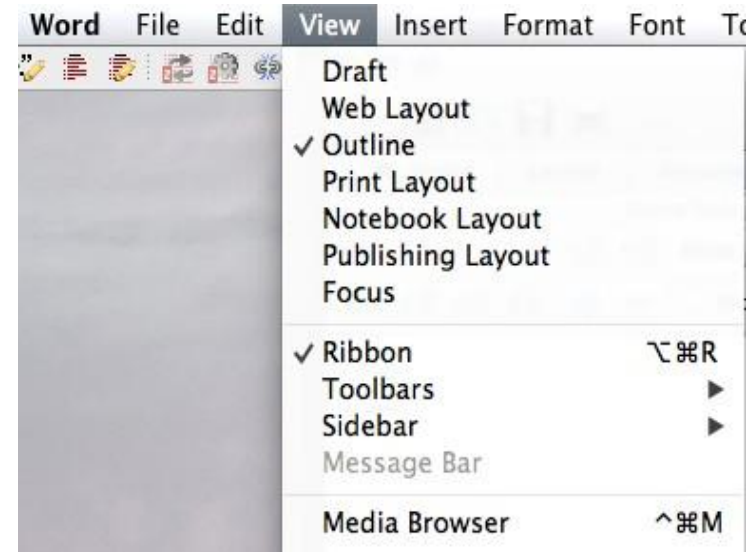
Use short and long periods of time to write.

Do not procrastinate! Just do it!

Outlining creates a clear chain of arguments, linked to supporting evidence, that leads **inevitably** to your message statement.



[How to Make and Format an Outline in Microsoft Word | Envato Tuts+ \(tutsplus.com\)](https://www.envato.com/tutsplus/how-to-make-and-format-an-outline-in-microsoft-word/)
[How To Create an Outline in Microsoft Word \(youtube.com\)](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=...)

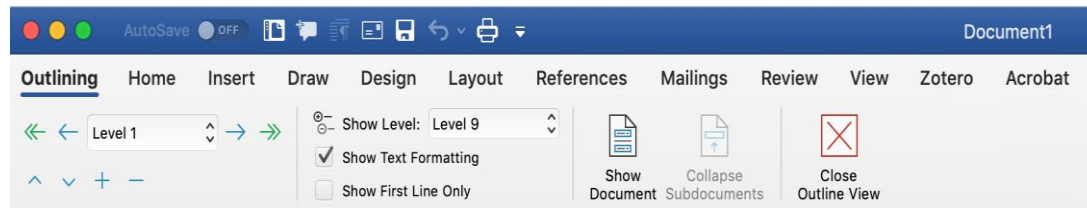
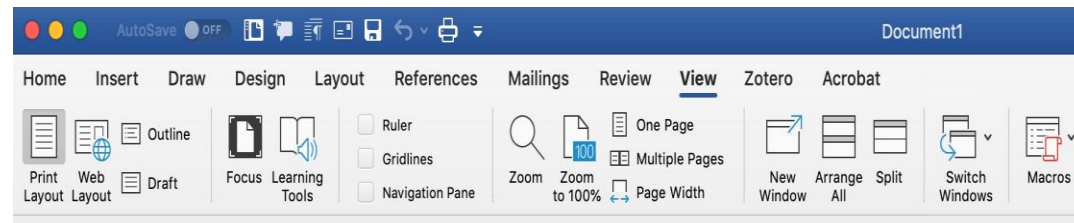


Microsoft Word is excellent for outlining. You can use outlines to take the step between mind-mapping and writing.

Outlining differs slightly between German and English versions of MS Word

So erstellen Sie eine Word-Gliederung in 3 Schritten:

1. Öffnen Sie ein neues Word-Dokument und wählen Sie das Menü "Ansicht" aus.
2. Hier müssen Sie jetzt den Button "Gliederung" anklicken und können nun Überschriften oder Kapitelabschnitte eintragen (siehe Bild). In die verschiedenen Ebenen können Sie über die Pfeile, die Ebenen-Auswahl oder ganz einfach über die Tabulatoren-Taste (über "Shift") gelangen.
3. Wenn Sie die Gliederung vollständig eingetragen haben, müssen Sie auf "Gliederungsansicht schließen" klicken und bekommen nun Ihre Gliederung angezeigt. Das Design können Sie über die "Formatvorlagen" in "Start" noch variieren.
4. Nach Anlegen der Gliederung müssen Sie die einzelnen Punkte nur noch mit Inhalt füllen.



Build a skeleton of your paper/thesis based on your outline

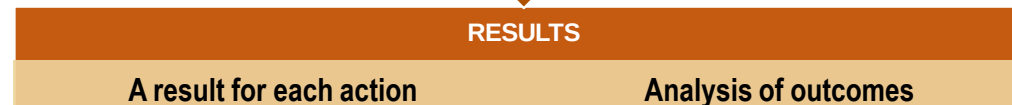
- Why did you start?



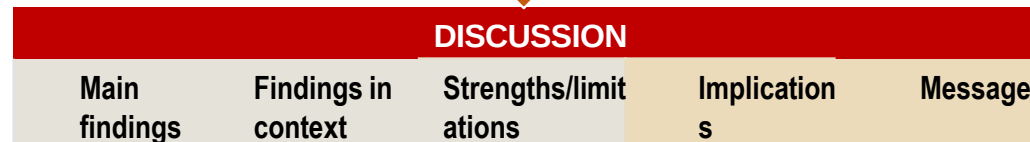
- What did you do?



- What did you find?

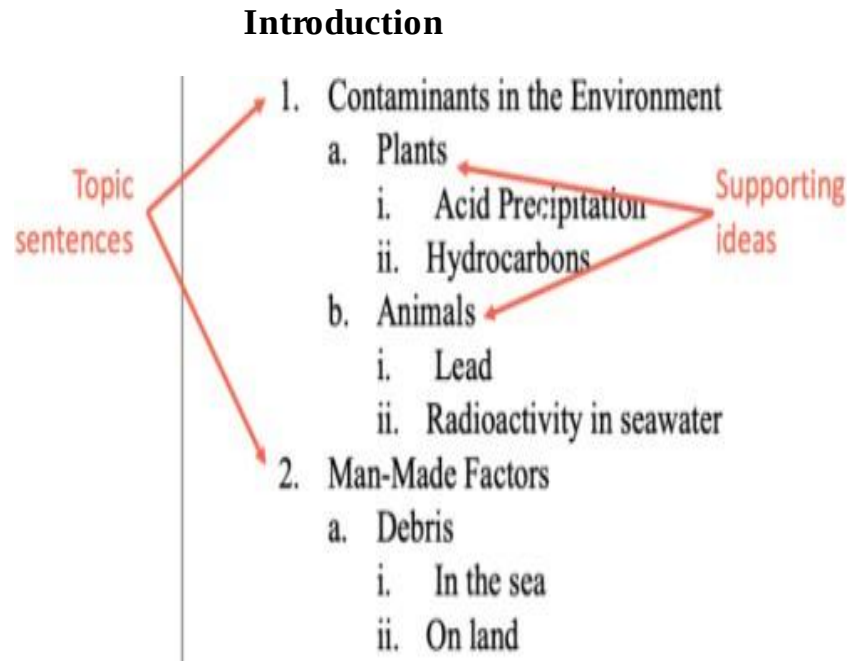


- What does it mean?



Fill in your outline with phrases first

- Rewriting is hard, so jot notes first, write later
- Get your ideas and important details on paper/screen, so you can see them all
- Focus on “unrolling” your argument to your audience
- Don’t commit to full sentences until you think your argument unrolls/flows properly
- Write topic sentences after the argument flows properly
- Organize detail sentences to support topic sentences



Fill in your
outline as you
go – it will
help you to
start writing

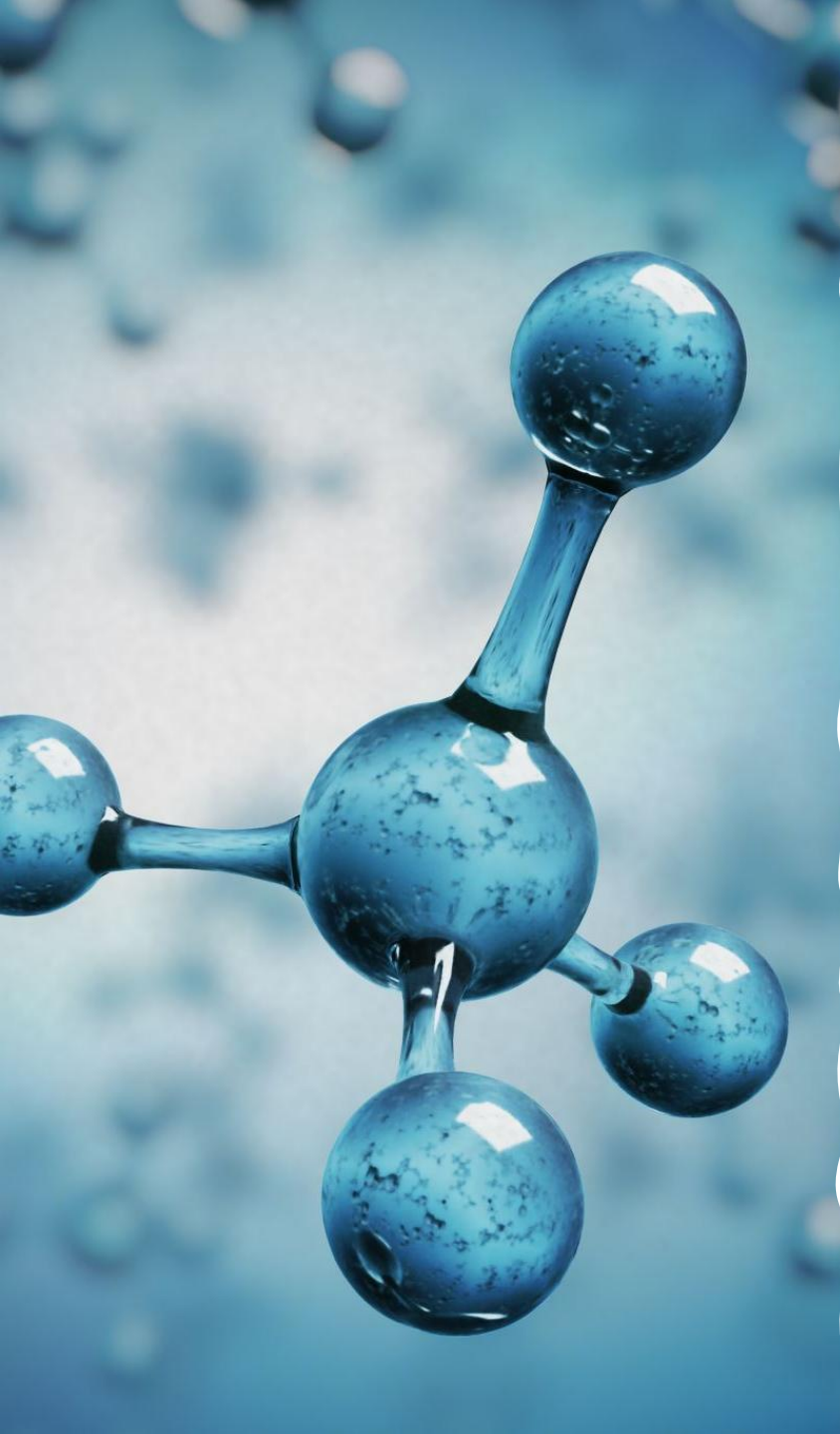
- It's never too early to start writing: start with your research question (problem)
- Write your study design into your manuscript
- Write your methods as you devise them
- Update your methods as you perform them
- Write your results as you obtain them
- State your limitations and strengths as you discover them
- Write the first half of your message sentence when you finish your analysis
- Write the second half of your message sentence when you think through the implications of your finding
- Put your results in context: Introduce the studies you compare your results to
- Choose your target journal and expand the outline into paragraphs, adapting as necessary



Reviewing assignments

Part focus of the course: how to review texts and each other's writing

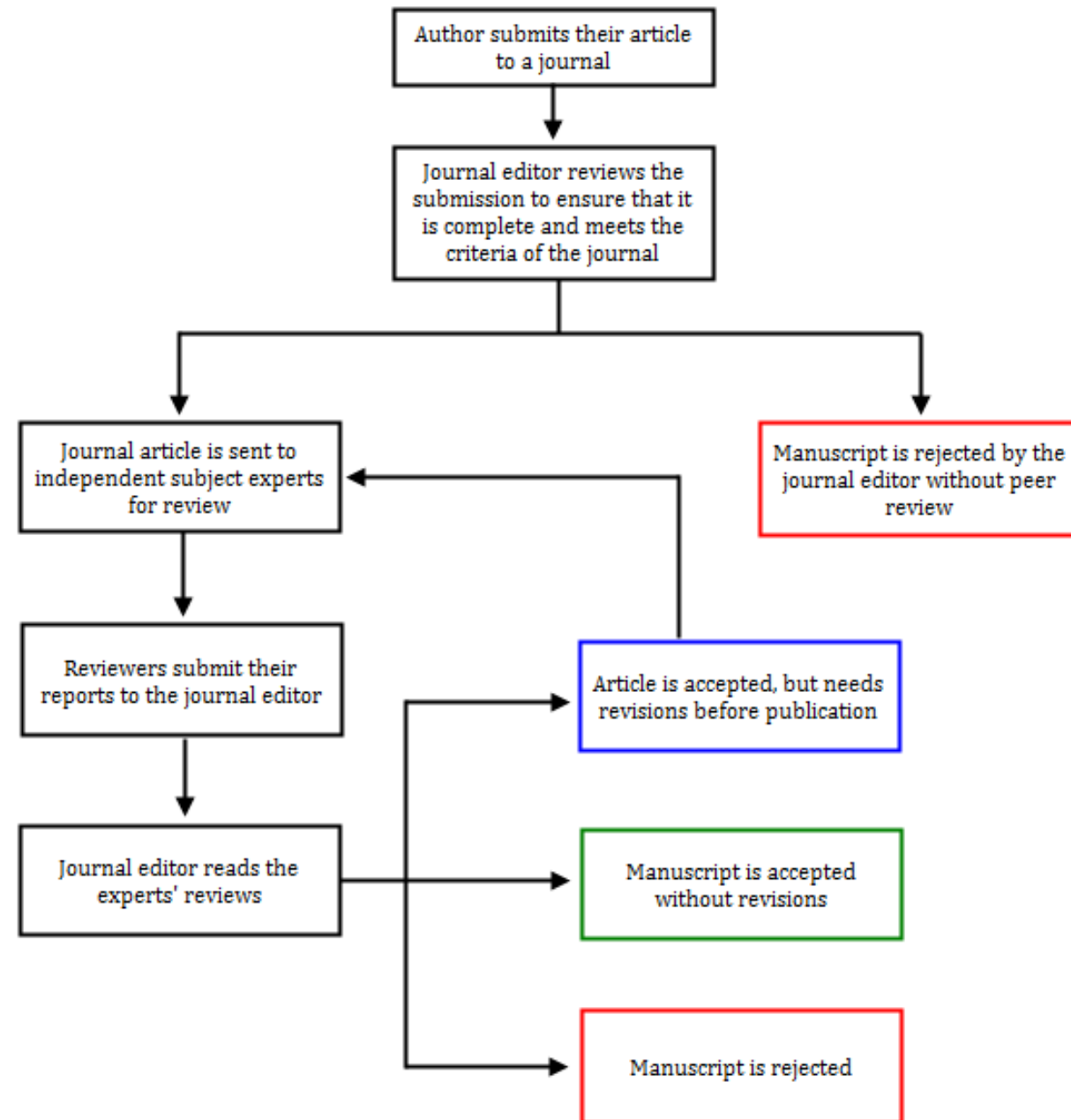
- Explanation of review process used in the class
- Explanation of the feedback grid used for reviewing
- Uploading all assignments on time **and reviewing** the 4 portfolio assignments form part of the course requirements.



Reviewing scientific publications

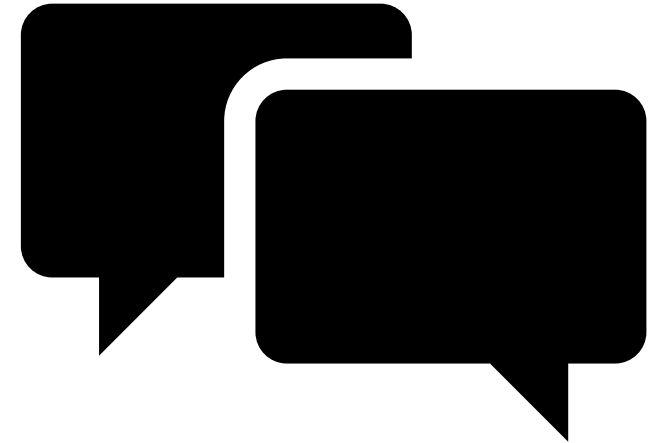
- Why?
- Who?
- How?

The peer review
process followed
by journals



Discuss these questions

- In your opinion, what should be the **aims** and focus of your peer reviews of assignments?
- How could you **benefit** from writing and receiving peer reviews?
- How would you describe the **attitude** of the reviewer?



Benefits of peer feedback

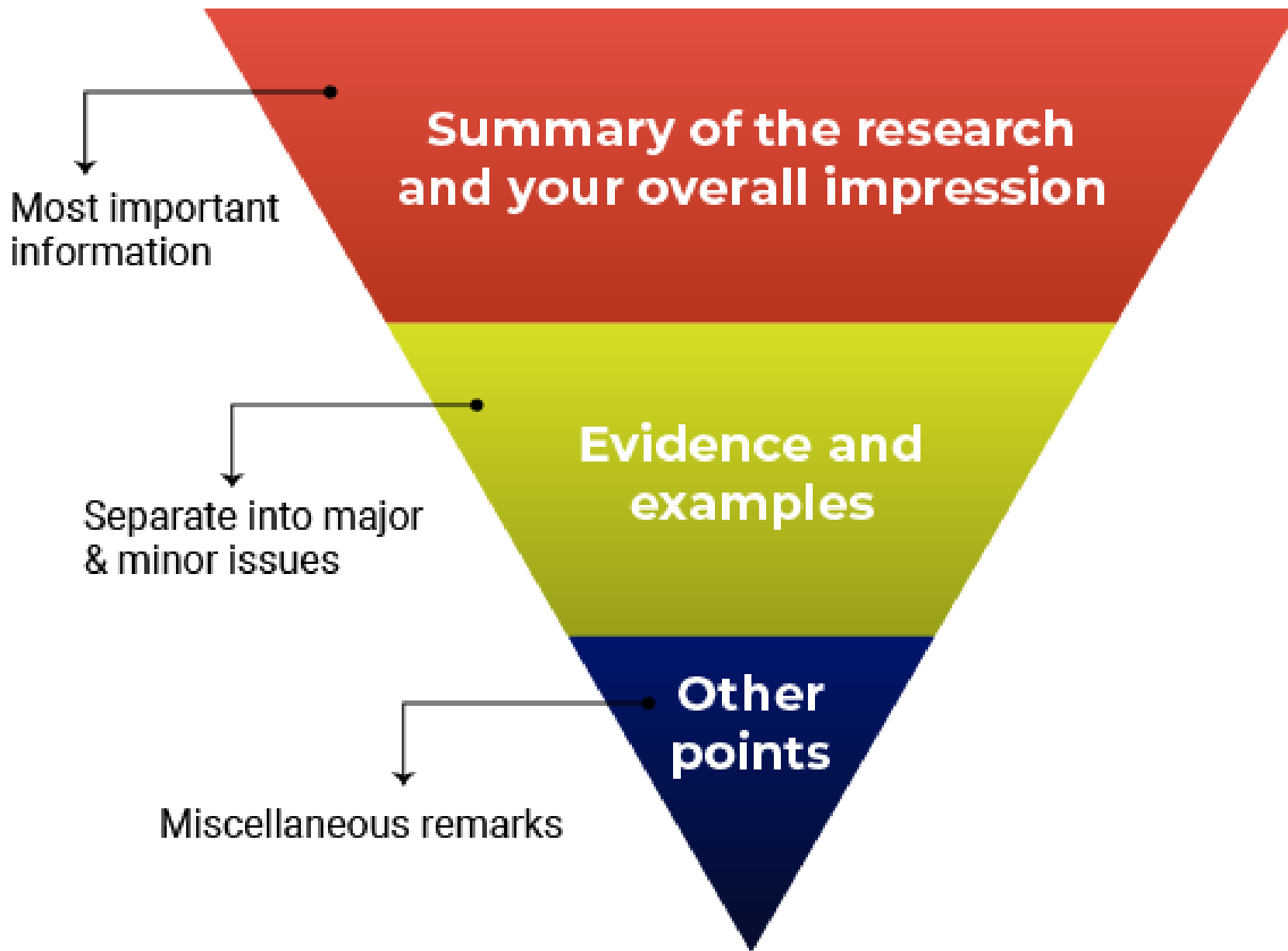
- Get to know your peers and learn about their study topics.
- Receive feedback from someone who might be less familiar with your topic, which helps to check the clarity of your text.
- Studies have confirmed the benefits of peer review in improving various aspects of writing: “...when students actively engage in the reciprocal process of peer review, their **concepts and knowledge about both writing and subject matter are further developed** (Jonassen et al., 1995), and **learning is enhanced** (Falchikov, 2001). Peer review is also beneficial for **developing students’ audience awareness, fostering social skills** such as learning how to **provide and accept critical comments, justifying one’s own position**, and declining nonproductive suggestions (Topping, 2009).“

Wu, Y. and Schunn, C.D. American Educational Research Journal June 2021, Vol. 58, No. 3, pp. 492–526 DOI: 10.3102/0002831220945266
<https://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/EJ1294485.pdf>

Why peer review?

Some benefits of giving peer feedback

	BENEFIT	CONSTRAINT
Cognitive	1. Exercise thinking 2. Take active role in learning 3. Engage in exploratory talk 4. Build critical skills 5. Demonstrate and reinforce knowledge 6. Build audience awareness	1. Uncertainty concerning peers' comments 2. Lack of learner investment
Social	1. Enhance communicative power 2. Receive authentic feedback 3. Gain confidence and reduce apprehension 4. Establish collegial ties and friendship 5. Influence learners' affective state	1. Discomfort and uneasiness 2. Lack of security in negotiating meaning 3. Commentary may be over critical
Linguistic	1. Enhance metalinguistic knowledge 2. Explore linguistic knowledge 3. Gain additional language skill practice 4. Enhance participation and improve discourse 5. Find right words to express ideas	1. Too much focus on surface structure 2. Lack of L2 formal schemata 3. Difficulty in understanding foreign accent
Practical	1. Applicable across students proficiency levels 2. Flexible across different stages in the writing process 3. Time-efficient in some cases 4. Reinforces process writing	1. Time constraints 2. Counter-productive feedback 3. Lack of student preparation



- [How to write a peer review](#) of a research paper

Higher Order

- Focus and Purpose
- Audience
- Organization and Document Design
- Development
- Readability

Lower Order

- Sentence Structure
- Punctuation
- Word Choice
- Spelling

Higher Order Concerns vs. Lower Order Concerns

How can I be a good peer reviewer?

- Watch the following video [on how to address Higher, Middle and Lower Order Concerns when peer reviewing](#)
- (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kMWZBDUIHUA>)

Higher Order Concerns (HOCs) vs. Lower Order Concerns (LOCs) when reviewing

(Adapted from <https://owl.excelsior.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/2/2019/04/How-to-Address-HOC-and-LOC.pdf>)

Higher Order Concerns address the “bigger picture” components of a written assignment. Always address the HOCs first!

- Main idea/Section focus and clarity
- Attention to audience and purpose
- Paragraphing
- Logical flow and organization
- Missing information/ideas/data
- Redundant/Extraneous information
- Enhancing development of ideas, thoughts, research narrative

Middle Order concerns mainly concern style

- Are sentences clear and easy to follow?
- Does the text flow – are ideas linked logically?
- Is the word choice engaging and appropriate?

When writing style prevents an author from communicating effectively, it becomes a HOC. If prose communicates ideas clearly, but lacks flair, style becomes a LOC.

Lower Order Concerns address mainly language use, minor changes and editing/proofreading

- Grammar, punctuation, spelling
- Word choice, vocabulary
- Sentence structure
- Referencing, citation accuracy

Such language problems do not normally make or break a text, but when they obscure an author’s ability to communicate effectively, they become HOCs.

Peer review instructions

- Follow the review process and review schedule.
- Strictly adhere to due dates.
- Remain polite.
- Find something supportive to say.
- Write a developmental review: give constructive advice.
- Complete the feedback grid.
- Write a reviewer's summary paragraph.
- Point out Higher, Middle and Lower Order Concerns.

When you are on the receiving side of a peer review:

Try not to be too possessive of your writing, but be open to changes.

Reviewing can be tough: develop a thick skin!



Review: summary paragraph example 1

- The document '**Instructions for assignments**' on ADAM contains full instructions for the assignments, the peer review process in this course, including the peer review schedule (who reviews whose assignment), as well as the due dates for uploading the various drafts.
- During reviewing, students write a reviewer's summary paragraph of the reviewed assignment, as well as point out Higher, Middle and Lower Order Concerns in the writing.

Example of a reviewer's summary paragraph of an introduction section:

In this introduction, the author stresses the urgent need for preventive or therapeutic interventions against Ebola [= indicating a gap]. He/she then presents a novel compound that promises to block viral replication not only in Ebola, but in a range of related viruses [= filling the gap].

The author needs to revise the correct way of citing texts, as he/she cites inconsistently. Furthermore, there are several mistakes in the use of grammatical articles. But overall, the information flows well, in well-structured paragraphs.

Reviewer's summary example 2

At the end of the paper, provide a reviewer's summary, a few sentences that address the paper as a whole, noting what works well and what needs improvement. For example:

Hi Percy—

I enjoyed reading your paper on the recent rise in popularity of organic foods. I think you have a strong thesis, and you support it with convincing evidence, especially in your paragraphs on Whole Foods and Trader Joe's. However, the paragraph on farmers' markets seems rather weak to me. I understand what you mean, but it reads more like opinion than fact. Are there any sources you could cite to make it sound more authoritative? I also wanted to mention that you often use the word "product," but I think you might mean "produce." Are those just typos? If you really mean "product," then you might want to define the term. I pointed out a few produce/product places for you above. Let me know if you have any questions about my comments.

Happy revising!

Annabeth

Developmental review

Provide **developmental reviews**: be specific about the problems in the manuscript and make suggestions as to how the problems might be addressed.

Provide written feedback so that the author can refer to it when s/he revises the paper. Be specific.

- POOR: “This is great!”
- BETTER: “Great—this example really supports what you said in the last paragraph. (Maybe it should go in the last paragraph instead of here?)”
- POOR: “This doesn’t make sense.”
- BETTER: “I don’t understand this—you said X above, but now you’re saying Y, which seems like the complete opposite. Do you really mean both?”

If you notice patterns of errors (for example, a word that is consistently misspelled, like produce/product above, or a punctuation mark that is consistently used incorrectly), then point out the pattern rather than marking all the errors.



How to review manuscripts

Peer review, your role and responsibilities

- How to review manuscripts.
- From the Elsevier website:
- <https://www.elsevier.com/connect/how-to-review-manuscripts-your-ultimate-checklist>

Peer review

...is critical because it

- Improves the quality of the published paper
- Ensures previous work is acknowledged
- Determines the importance of findings
- Detects plagiarism and fraud
- Plays a central role in academic career development

...adheres to the principles that

- It is a well understood concept
- Without it there is no control in scientific communication
- Journal editors evaluate and reject certain articles prior to external peer review

Why should you review?



Editors' view: what makes a good reviewer?

- Provides a thorough and comprehensive report
- Submits the report on time
- Provides well-founded comments for authors
- Gives constructive criticism
- Demonstrates objectivity
- Provides a clear recommendation to the editor

Comments to the editor

1

Comment on novelty and significance

2

Recommend whether the manuscript is suitable for publication

3

Confidential comments will not be disclosed to the author(s)

Your ultimate checklist for reviewing a paper

First impressions

- Is the research original, novel and important to the field?
- Has the appropriate structure and language been used?

Abstract

- Is it really a summary?
- Does it include key findings?
- Is it an appropriate length?

Introduction

- Is it effective, clear and well organized?
- Does it really introduce and put into perspective what follows?
- Suggest changes in organization and point authors to appropriate citations.
- Be specific – don't write "the authors have done a poor job"

Methodology

- Can a colleague reproduce the experiments and get the same outcomes?
- Did the authors include proper references to previously published methodology?
- Is the description of new methodology accurate?
- Could or should the authors have included supplementary material?

Results and discussion

- Suggest improvements in the way data is shown
- Comment on general logic and on justification of interpretations and conclusions
- Comment on the number of figures, tables and schemes
- Write concisely and precisely which changes you recommend
- List separately suggested changes in style, grammar and other small changes
- Suggest additional experiments or analyses
- Make clear the need for changes/updates
- Ask yourself whether the manuscript should be published at all

Conclusion

- Comment on importance, validity and generality of conclusions
- Request toning down of unjustified claims and generalizations
- Request removal of redundancies and summaries
- The abstract, not the conclusion, summarizes the study

References, tables and figures

- Check accuracy, number and citation appropriateness
- Comment on any footnotes
- Comment on figures, their quality and readability
- Assess completeness of legends, headers and axis labels
- Check presentation consistency
- Comment on need for colour in figures

Peer review questions to consider when reviewing a full article or proposal

- **Introduction.** Is the first paragraph an adequate statement of the manuscript's topic and approach? Did you know from the first paragraph where the paper was headed?
- **Continuity.** Is the line of argument (the 'golden thread') clear from paragraph to paragraph? Did each paragraph add to the argument?
- **Evidence.** Did the writer support the argument in a convincing manner?
- **Conclusion.** Does the conclusion draw together the strands of the argument? Is it a sufficient statement of the paper's main points?
- **Strengths.** What did you find best in the paper/text?
- What still requires improvement?

The assignment review process 1

Naming
assignment
example:
1Peter.Smith
first draft

- Follow the instructions on the document 'Instructions for assignments' on ADAM.
- That document contains the peer review schedule, so you can identify your reviewer for each assignment.
- By the due date, authors upload their WORD-format assignment for peer review to the folder entitled 'Assignment X First Draft' on ADAM, using the naming conventions explained on page 1. This first draft also requires upload to Turnitin if instructed. (Some assignments require upload to Padlet.)
- During Manuscript Clinics and in between classes, the reviewer reviews and corrects the assignment and makes comments (using 'Track changes'). Reviewers **also write a short review paragraph** (summary, main recommendations, HOCs and LOCs).
- Thereafter, the reviewer uploads the assignment (with comments) to the ADAM folder entitled 'REVIEWED DRAFT' by the due date, naming it X surname name reviewed by YOUR NAME.

The assignment review process 2

- Each writer downloads his/her reviewed assignment from ADAM and makes changes as applicable before uploading the final version to the 'FINAL DRAFT' folder, adding 'final' to the document name (for example X Surname.Name final version).
- The lecturer corrects and comments on the assignments before uploading them to the 'TUTOR'S' COMMENTS' folder, adding her initials to the document name. We recommend that you read this version of your assignment before class, so that you can ask any questions you may have.
- Be rigorous about adhering to due dates in order not to delay the reviewing and marking process. **Participating fully and timely in the peer review process is a requirement for receiving credits for the course.**

Assignment 1

Write a 150-200-word text in which you:

- introduce yourself, your field of study, and the topic you are researching.
- justify why the topic and field are interesting and/or significant.
- use everyday language.

Write this text with pen and paper, without the use of digital or other help.

Take a photo of the text and type it up on Padlet, or upload the photo on Padlet.

- Do not copy and paste a text you have written for another purpose.

Upload this assignment to your column on the Padlet page of this course:

➤ https://sz-unibas.padlet.org/RianaPaola_szunibas/h8j5bz89xcbdw9vg